

FREE PROMPT PACK

Paris Through *Time*: the prompts

Every prompt I used to put myself into 200+ years of Paris history, from the storming of the Bastille in 1789 to the streets of Paris in October 2026. Copy, paste, swap in your own details.

BY WOMEN LEAD AI · WOMENLEAD.AI

BEFORE YOU START

Look at the moment, *not the camera*

This is part 3 of my Through Time series. In New York I walked through the city in each era. In London I made the historic moment happen on camera. For Paris I added one more rule: I always look at the moment. When the Bastille falls I run with the crowd towards it. When Notre-Dame burns, the camera watches over my shoulder, then turns to my face lit by the fire.

I visit eight moments: 1789, 1889, 1900, 1944, 2019, two in 2024, and 2026. I'm dressed for each era, an old paper calendar flips to every date, and each clip keeps its own sound.

WHAT YOU NEED

- **A Higgsfield account.** An 8 second clip at 1080p costs 128 credits, a 5 second clip 80. Images cost under a credit each. My final clips came to just over 1,100 credits, plus a few redos.
- **2 or 3 clear photos of your face.** Front and three quarter, natural light, no heavy filters.
- **A list of real moments with real dates.** Check each one before you build a scene around it.
- **A video editor** such as CapCut, or Claude Code, to add the calendar and stitch the clips.

Each video clip took about 4 to 6 minutes to render. Start one, then write the next prompt while you wait.

THE FOUR STEPS

1. **Dress for every era:** one character sheet per moment, with your face.
2. **Set the scene:** one still photo per angle, so you see the shot before you pay for video.
3. **Bring it to life:** animate each still with sound, using two angles when you react to something.
4. **Add the calendar:** add the dates in your edit and stitch it all together.

Go to Higgsfield here: higgsfield.ai

Before step 1

Pick moments *you can see*

A great moment has something that changes in front of the camera: a drawbridge drops, a spire falls, bells ring out over a crowd. If nothing happens, it's just a nice costume photo.



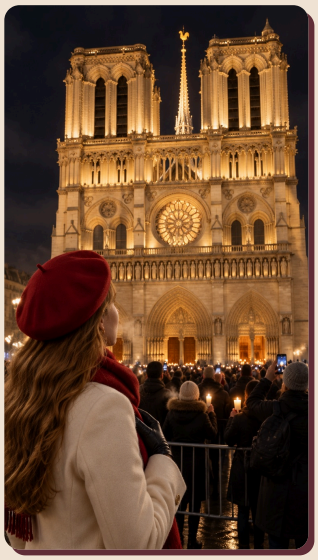
1889: the tower opens



1944: Paris is liberated



2019: Notre-Dame burns



2024: Notre-Dame reopens

MY MOMENTS

1789	The storming of the Bastille (14 July 1789)
1889	The Eiffel Tower opens to the public at the Exposition Universelle (15 May 1889)
1900	The first Paris Métro line opens (19 July 1900)
1944	The Liberation of Paris (25 August 1944)
2019	The fire at Notre-Dame (15 April 2019)
2024	The Olympic opening ceremony on the Seine (26 July 2024)
2024	Notre-Dame reopens (7 December 2024)
2026	Riots in central Paris after the cost-of-living protests (18 October 2026)

Two in one year is fine. Put the day and month on the calendar as well as the year, so 26 July and 7 December don't look like the same scene.

Step 1

Dress for *every era*

A character sheet locks your face and outfit so you look the same in every shot. Make one per moment. In Higgsfield go to Images, pick **GPT Image 2.5**, aspect ratio 16:9, and upload 3 photos of your face as references.

```
Character reference sheet of the woman in the reference photos, dressed as [WHO SHE IS, WHERE AND WHEN, e.g. a young working woman of Paris on 14 July 1789, the day of the storming of the Bastille]. Keep her face EXACTLY as in the photos: [EYES], natural skin with real texture, [LIP COLOUR FOR THE ERA]. Do not beautify, slim or change her face in any way.
Costume, historically accurate for [PLACE AND YEAR]: [PASTE YOUR OUTFIT LINE]. Hair: her own [HAIR COLOUR] hair [HAIRSTYLE FOR THE ERA].
Layout on a plain warm light grey studio background: on the left a large close-up portrait facing camera; in the middle a full-length front view standing naturally; then a full-length side view and a full-length back view. Soft even studio light, photorealistic photography, natural proportions, real fabric texture. No text, no labels, no logos, no watermark.
```



Do this: keep the words "do not beautify", and check the sheet really looks like you before you spend credits on video. Everything after this depends on it.

Step 1

My outfit lines, *ready to paste*

Drop one of these into the costume line of the prompt above.

ERA	OUTFIT LINE
1789	a fitted short indigo blue cotton caraco jacket with elbow-length sleeves, a white muslin fichu crossed over the chest and tucked in, a full ankle-length skirt in red and cream vertical stripes, a plain linen apron, a white linen mob cap with a frilled edge and a green ribbon pinned to it as a cockade, sturdy brown leather buckled shoes
1889	a sage green and ivory silk day dress with a fitted boned bodice buttoned to a high collar, narrow long sleeves, a draped overskirt gathered over a small late-1880s bustle, a small tilted straw hat trimmed with pale pink silk flowers, cream kid gloves, a closed cream lace parasol
1900	a white cotton lingerie blouse with pin tucks, lace insertion and a high lace collar, a lavender linen walking skirt flaring to the floor, a narrow lavender belt, a wide cream straw picture hat with lavender tulle and white ostrich feathers, short white gloves; hair in a full soft pompadour
1944	a knee-length cornflower blue rayon tea dress with a small white daisy print, padded shoulders, short puffed sleeves, a little white collar, a belted waist, tall cork wedge sandals, a tricolour ribbon rosette at the chest; hair in 1940s victory rolls, classic red lip
2019	a black leather biker jacket, a navy and white striped Breton top, high-waisted straight blue jeans cropped at the ankle, white leather trainers, a small black leather crossbody bag
2024 (July)	a white broderie anglaise cotton midi sundress, a clear plastic rain poncho, white canvas trainers, three thin painted stripes of blue, white and red on one cheek
2024 (Dec)	a long ivory double-breasted wool coat, a black fine-knit roll-neck, black wide-leg wool trousers, black leather gloves, a red wool beret worn tilted, a red wool scarf
2026	an oversized charcoal grey wool coat, a cream chunky knit jumper, black straight trousers, black leather trainers, a black canvas tote bag, wired earphones around the neck

History check: on 14 July 1789 the crowd wore green cockades. The red, white and blue one only arrived on 17 July. Small details like this are what make people comment.

Step 2

Set the scene, *two angles*

Before any video, make one still per shot with GPT Image 2.5 at 9:16. References: the character sheet first, then two photos of your face. A still costs almost nothing, so you can fix the scene before you pay for video.

The rule that fixed my video: when you face the camera with the event behind you, it looks like you're looking the wrong way. So for every reaction I made two stills. One from behind, looking at the event. One from the front, with the event behind the camera, so your eyes point at it.



Angle A: over my shoulder, towards the fire



Angle B: the fire is behind the camera

```
Photorealistic vertical 9:16 film still. CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1
(character sheet) with the face from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not
beautified, wearing exactly the outfit from the character sheet: [SHORT OUTFIT LINE].
ONLY she has this face; every other person is a clearly different person, nobody dressed
like her.
HISTORIC MOMENT: [DATE], [THE EVENT IN ONE LINE].
CAMERA ANGLE: [A: OVER HER SHOULDER from behind, she faces AWAY from the camera, towards
the event] or [B: a close-up from the FRONT, the event is behind the camera and NOT
visible; she looks just past the lens at it].
SETTING: [PLACE, LIGHT, CROWD, WHAT IS HAPPENING].
COMPOSITION: [WHERE SHE STANDS IN THE FRAME, HER EXPRESSION].
Shot on 35mm, [LIGHT], real depth of field, photoreal. No text, no logos, no watermark.
```

Step 3

Bring it *to life*

Go to Videos and pick **Seedance 2.5**. Settings: 1080p, 9:16, audio on. 8 seconds for a single shot, 5 seconds for each of two angles. Add your still as the **start frame**, then the character sheet and two photos of your face as references.

```
Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER: the woman from the start frame, Reference
Image 1 (character sheet) and the real photos, exactly this face in every frame, not
beautified, wearing exactly the outfit from the character sheet: [SHORT OUTFIT LINE].
ONLY she has this face; every other person is a clearly different person.
HISTORIC MOMENT: [DATE], [THE EVENT].
SETTING: exactly as in the start frame: [A SHORT RECAP OF THE SCENE].
ACTION: [WHAT HAPPENS IN FRONT OF HER]; [HER REACTION]; [HOW THE SHOT ENDS].
CAMERA: one continuous shot, [CAMERA MOVE], 9:16 vertical, never cuts. [LIGHT AND FILM
LOOK], real fabric and hair physics, photoreal, natural proportions, five fingers, no
morphing.
AUDIO: [3 TO 5 SOUNDS FROM THE MOMENT], no speech to camera, no music.
```

SOUND FOR EACH MOMENT

1789	a roaring crowd, running feet on cobbles, drums, musket shots
1889	a distant brass band waltz, gravel footsteps, fountains, chatter
1900	footsteps on stone steps, hooves, an approaching train underground
1944	tank tracks on cobbles, a cheering crowd, church bells
2019	a roaring fire across the water, sirens, a gasping crowd
2024	heavy rain on ponchos, a roaring crowd, an orchestral fanfare
2024	cathedral bells, wind, applause, a faint choir and organ
2026	crackling fire, sirens, distant shouting, glass under her trainers

Step 3

My 2019 close-up, *word for word*



```
Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER: the woman
from the start frame, Reference Image 1 (character
sheet) and the real photos, exactly this face in every
frame, not beautified, wearing exactly the outfit from
the character sheet: black leather biker jacket, striped
Breton top, long loose wavy honey-brown hair with
curtain bangs, red lips. ONLY she has this face; every
other person is a clearly different person.
HISTORIC MOMENT: the evening of 15 April 2019, the fire
at Notre-Dame de Paris, which is in front of her, behind
the camera and never visible.
ACTION: close-up of her face lit by flickering orange
firelight; she stares ahead past the lens at the fire
with her hand over her mouth; a sudden brighter flare of
orange light washes over her face as the spire falls,
she flinches, her hand drops from her mouth, a tear runs
down her cheek; behind her the out-of-focus people also
react, looking the same way as her.
CAMERA: one continuous very slow push in on her face,
9:16 vertical, never cuts. Shot on 35mm, warm orange
firelight on her face against the cool blue dusk behind,
shallow depth of field, fine grain, real hair physics,
photoreal, natural proportions, five fingers, no
morphing.
AUDIO: the roar and crackle of a huge fire, distant
sirens, a crowd gasping, someone quietly singing a hymn,
no speech to camera, no music.
```

Why it works: you never see the cathedral in this shot, only its light on my face. Angle A shows the spire fall, angle B shows how it felt.

Step 4

Add *the calendar*

The calendar isn't made by the AI. AI video garbles numbers, so add the dates yourself in the edit. That way every date is exact.



1. Open with a title for the first 3 seconds. Mine says "200+ years of PARIS history".
2. Make an old tear-off calendar page for each date: yellowed paper, a red strip at the top with the city name, the year in an old-style serif, the day and month underneath.
3. Over the start of each clip, flip quickly through the years in between and land on the new date. Add a soft paper flick sound to every page.
4. Once it lands, show the name of the moment underneath on two short lines.
5. Keep it off your face in every shot. In close-ups I moved it down to the left, and it glides there during the crossfade.
6. Join two angles with a quarter second crossfade, not a hard cut, and trim the last few frames of the first angle. Hard cuts between angles look jittery.
7. Stitch the moments in date order and keep each clip's own sound.

Shortcut: I added the calendar later with Claude Code. Describe the look above and ask it to build the calendar as an overlay and stitch the whole video for you.

LEARN FROM MY REDOS

Five fixes that *saved my clips*

1. **Look at the event.** My first Bastille clip had me facing the camera while the crowd ran the other way. I remade it with me running with them, from behind and then from the front.
2. **Make the still first.** A still costs almost nothing. Fix the costume, crowd and light in the still, then animate it. It's much cheaper than redoing a video.
3. **No hard cuts between angles.** Trim the last few frames of the first angle and crossfade. Seedance clips can wobble right at the end.
4. **Check close-ups for overlays.** The calendar sat on my face in four shots. Watch every close-up and move it out of the way.
5. **Check the details.** The Eiffel Tower was red-brown in 1889, not bronze. The Bastille crowd wore green cockades. Zoom into every still for flags and signs that shouldn't be there.

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